

The canes are cut when they are 14 to 16 feet (5 to 7 meters) high.

The canes are ripe when they look dry.



Sugar cane is often harvested by machine, but in some places it is still cut by hand.

Maple syrup

Maple syrup is made from the sap of sugar maple or black maple trees.

Holes are made in the trunks in winter when the trees are dormant.

When a thaw follows a freeze, the sap is collected from the wounds in buckets. Maple syrup is only produced in North America.



Sugar production

In a sugar factory, sugar from the canes or beet is taken out, cleaned, and boiled. This leaves a syrup which is turned into brown sugar crystals. These can be refined to make white sugar.

Sorts of sugar

Sugars differ in color and in the size of their crystals, or grains.

Granulated



Demerara



Dark soft brown



Muscovado

